

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ 10 7 4
 ♦ A Q 10 6 3
 ♣ Q 10

♠ A K 7 4
 ♥ K Q 9 6
 ♦ J 8
 ♣ 9 7 6



♠ Q 3
 ♥ A J 3 2
 ♦ K 9 5
 ♣ J 5 4 2

♠ J 10 9 6
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ 7 4 2
 ♣ A K 8 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠		
All Pass			
2 ♠ by South			

You have plenty good support to raise partner's ♣ suit. But your first priority is to show a 4-card Major suit if you have one. You do, so you respond 1 ♠. Partner raises you to 2 ♠.

Are you tempted to take partner back to ♣s since you have such good support? Don't be. Partner has 4 ♠s, but he might have only 3 ♣s.

Are you tempted to bid 3 ♠ since partner raised you? Don't be. He showed a minimum hand with his single raise and you only have 9 points. Just pass.

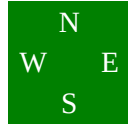
Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 8 5
 ♥ 7
 ♦ J 6 5
 ♣ K Q 9 7 4

♠ A K 9
 ♥ K Q 8 3
 ♦ Q 10 4 2
 ♣ 10 3



♠ 10 4 3 2
 ♥ 10 5 4 2
 ♦ 9 7
 ♣ A 6 2

♠ 7 6
 ♥ A J 9 6
 ♦ A K 8 3
 ♣ J 8 5

West	North	East	South
	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Some might jump to 2NT, "to show partner my point count". Some might jump to 3♦, "to force partner to game and show my ♦ support". The wise ones will just bid 1♥, striving to find an 8-card Major fit, the first priority of bidding.

You choose the 1♥ route, and partner obligingly says 2♥.

Remember "She who knows, goes"? You know of the 8-card Major fit. You know of at least 26 combined points. You know you should bid 4♥, so you do.